In Karnataka, they said, ‘daily gatherings and weekly gatherings called Milans are both growing in new places’.[29]

By the early 2010s, the RSS started expanding its social reach in the state through daily and weekly videos on dedicated Facebook and YouTube channels. Its Facebook page in the state is ‘largely in Kannada’.[30] By September 2021, the Kannada RSS Facebook page had 8,56,279 followers; its Kannada YouTube channel 2,70,000.[31] The state media in-charge explained to me that they approach Twitter and Facebook with different content strategies. Twitter, he said, ‘is not that important for people in vernacular audiences … it’s more to reach opinion-makers but Facebook is for mass-connect and we do it in Kannada.’ Each administrative region in the RSS has a media centre called Vishwa Swamvad Kendra (World Dialogue Centre). In Karnataka, this team comprised a central team of five people and a social media team of about four or five people, with one person each handling every zone in the state (the RSS divides Karnataka into six zones).[32]

Figure 12.4: RSS Online Membership—Interactive Live Tracker